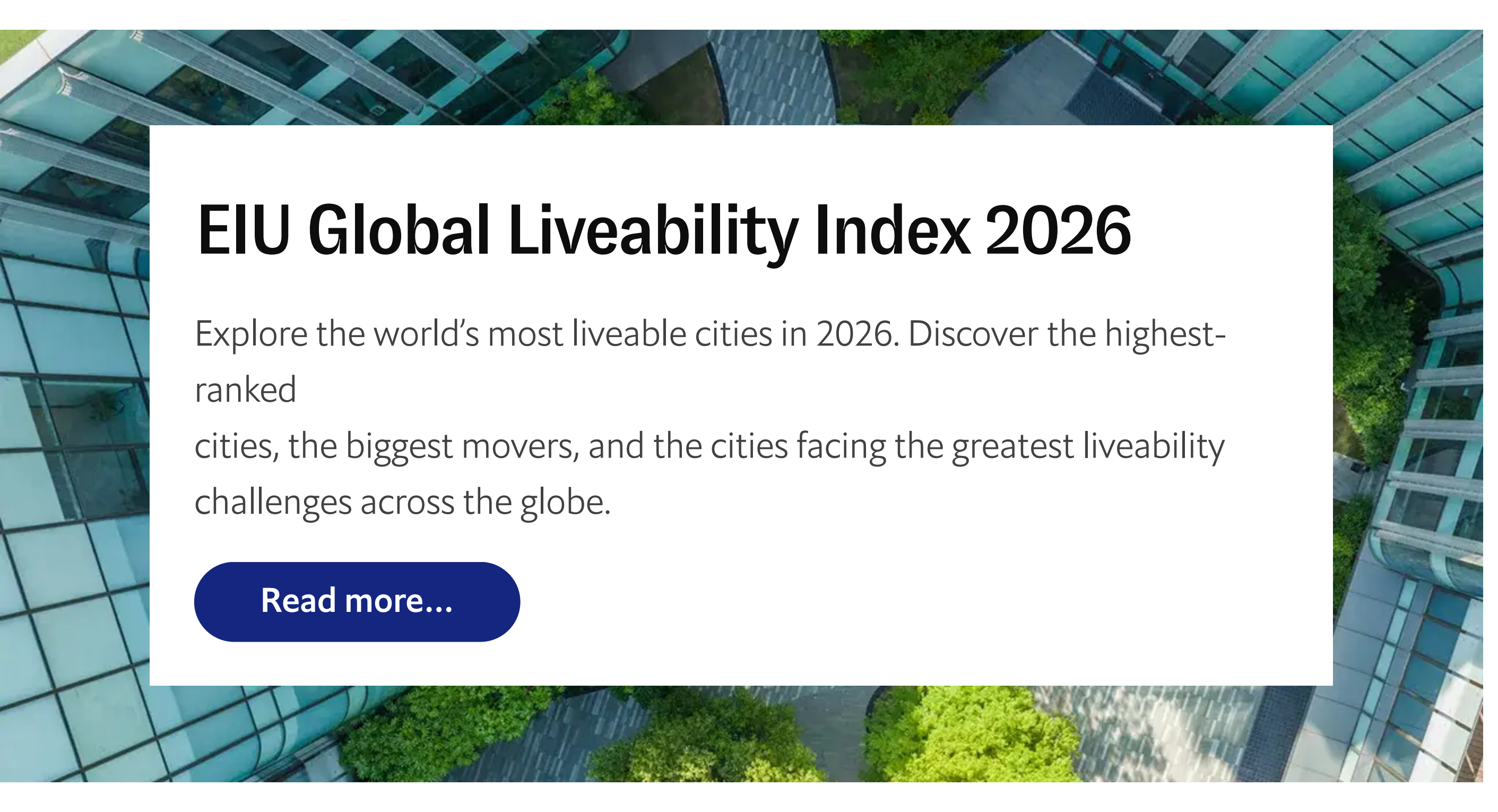
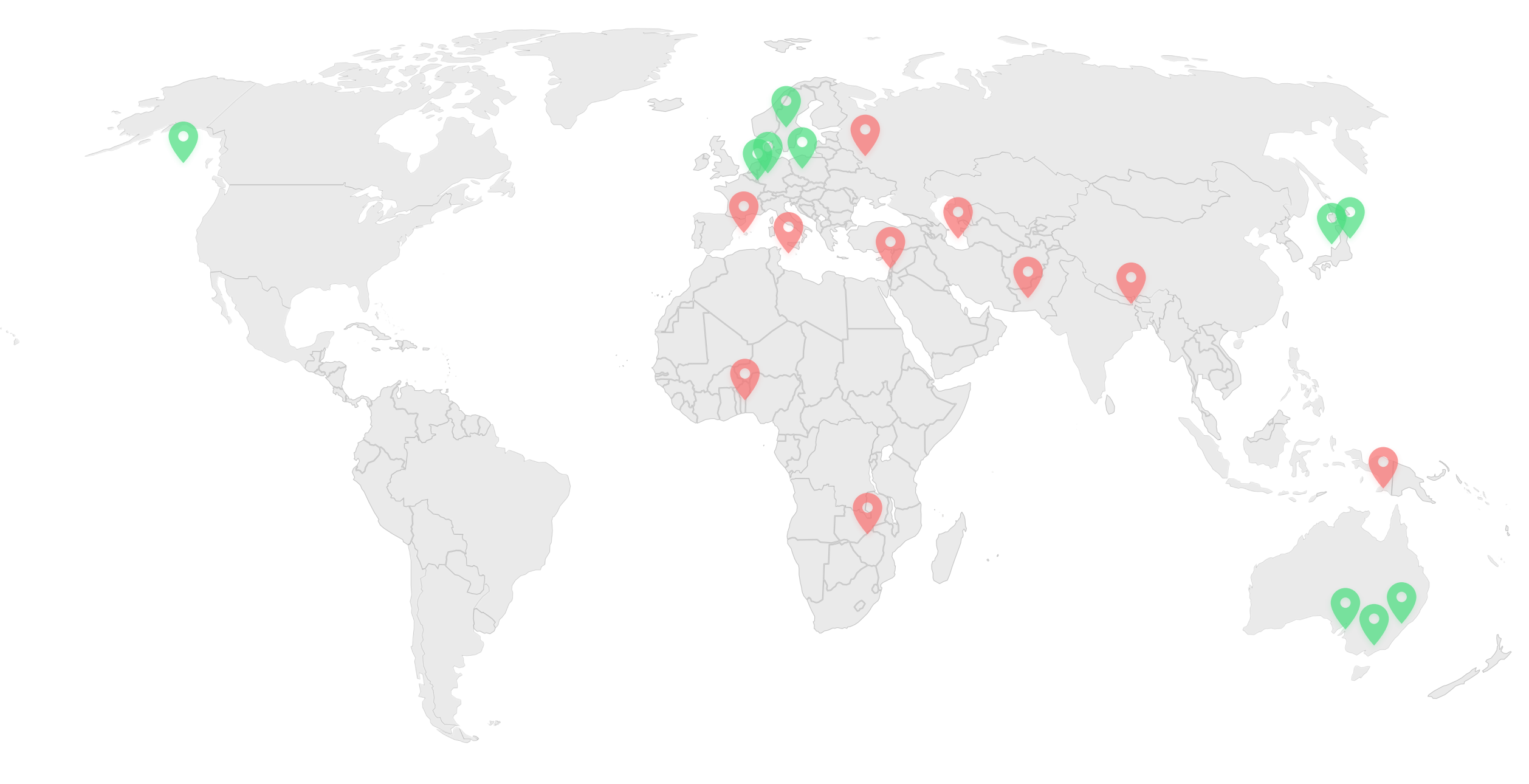


EIU Global Liveability Index 2026

Explore the world's most liveable cities in 2026. Discover the highest-ranked
cities, the biggest movers, and the cities facing the greatest liveability challenges across the globe.

Read more...



Top 10 Most Liveable Cities

Copenhagen retains its position as the world's most liveable city, followed by Vienna and Melbourne. The top ten continues to be dominated by cities in Australia, Switzerland, Japan and Canada.

01	Copenhagen DENMARK	UNCHANGED
02	Vienna AUSTRIA	
03	Melbourne AUSTRALIA	
04	Sydney AUSTRALIA	
05	Zurich SWITZERLAND	
06	Geneva SWITZERLAND	
07	Osaka JAPAN	
08	Adelaide AUSTRALIA	
09	Vancouver CANADA	
10	Tokyo JAPAN	

Biggest Movers Up

Asian cities recorded the strongest gains this year, driven largely by improvements in healthcare. New York also climbed following improvements in stability.

CITY	COUNTRY	2026 RANK	RANK CHANGE	OVERALL SCORE	SCORE CHANGE
Fuzhou	China	93	▲ 7	75	+1
Lisbon	Portugal	54	▲ 6	89	+1
Wuxi	China	106	▲ 4	72	+1
Nanjing	China	98	▲ 4	74	+1
Zhuhai	China	105	▲ 3	72	+1
Qingdao	China	114	▲ 4	70	+1
Tokyo	Japan	10	▲ 3	96	0
New York	US	66	▲ 3	87	+1
Shenyang	China	84	▲ 3	79	+1
Dalian	China	101	▲ 3	74	+1
Xi'an	China	102	▲ 3	73	+1
Johannesburg	South Africa	108	▲ 3	71	0
Rio de Janeiro	Brazil	108	▲ 3	71	0
Chongqing	China	113	▲ 3	70	+1
Guangzhou	China	104	▲ 3	73	+1

Biggest Movers Down

The largest declines were concentrated across the Middle East following deterioration in regional stability resulting from the Iran war.

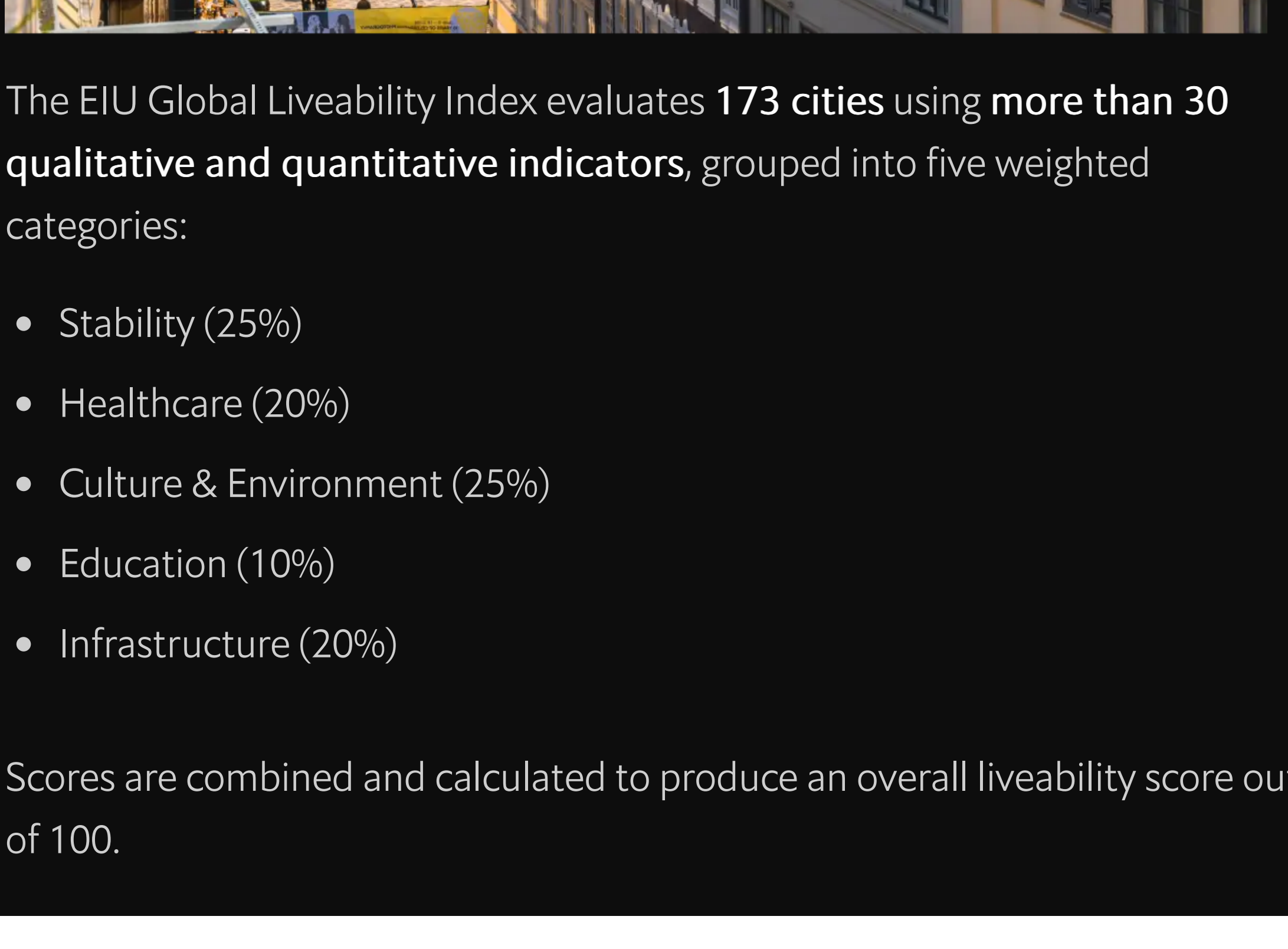
CITY	COUNTRY	2026 RANK	RANK CHANGE	OVERALL SCORE	SCORE CHANGE
Muscat	Oman	123	▼ 14	68	-4
Kuwait City	Kuwait	105	▼ 12	72	-3
Amman	Jordan	143	▼ 11	60	-3
Manama	Bahrain	116	▼ 10	70	-3
Doha	Qatar	108	▼ 7	71	-3
Auckland	New Zealand	12	▼ 5	95	-1
Luxembourg	Luxembourg	15	▼ 4	95	-1
Budapest	Hungary	36	▼ 4	91	-1
Portland	US	48	▼ 4	90	-1
Abu Dhabi	UAE	76	▼ 4	81	-3
Dubai	UAE	79	▼ 4	80	-3
Saipan	US	87	▼ 4	78	0
Zurich	Switzerland	5	▼ 3	96	-1
San Juan	Puerto Rico	83	▼ 3	79	0
Athens	Greece	88	▼ 3	78	0

Lowest Ranked Cities

The lowest-ranked cities continue to be affected by conflict, political instability and economic hardship, with stability remaining the weakest-performing category.

164	Tehran
165	Harare
166	Kyiv
167	Port Moresby
168	Lagos
169	Algiers
170	Karachi
171	Dhaka
172	Tripoli
173	Damascus

How is Liveability Measured?



The EIU Global Liveability Index evaluates **173 cities** using **more than 30 qualitative and quantitative indicators**, grouped into five weighted categories:

- Stability (25%)
- Healthcare (20%)
- Culture & Environment (25%)
- Education (10%)
- Infrastructure (20%)

Scores are combined and calculated to produce an overall liveability score out of 100.

Registered in England and Wales. No. 236383 | Registered office: The Adelphi, 1-11 John Adam Street, London, WC2N 6HT | VAT Reg No: GB 340 436 876 © 2026 Economist Enterprise EIU. All rights reserved.